



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*rāgadveṣau manodharmau na manaste kadācana |
nīrvikalpo+asi bodhātmā nīrvikāraḥ sukhaṁ cara | |15|5| |
sarvabhūteṣu cātmānaṁ sarvabhūtāni cātmani |
vijñāya nirahaṁkāro nirmamastvaṁ sukhī bhava | |15|6| |
viśvaṁ sphurati yatredaṁ taraṅgā iva sāgare |
tattvameva na sandehaścinmūrte vijvaro bhava | |15|7| |*

— Aṣṭāvakragītā, Prakaraṇa 15 (Chapter 15), Verses 5-7

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Delving into the nature of reality, Aṣṭāvakra continues to guide us towards liberation. He reminds you that attachment and aversion, like and dislike, are simply mental constructs. They are qualities of the mind, but you are not the mind. You are pure awareness, untouched by these fleeting emotions. You are inherently free from these fluctuations. Aṣṭāvakra urges you to recognize this fundamental truth and to live in joy, unbound by the mind's incessant chatter. This freedom from mental constructs allows you to experience a profound and lasting peace.

The next verse speaks to the interconnectedness of all things. Aṣṭāvakra advises you to see yourself in all beings and to see all beings within yourself. This is not merely a philosophical concept, but a practical guide to living with compassion and understanding. By recognizing the unity of all existence, you dissolve the ego, the sense of separate self. When you are free from ego and possessiveness, you naturally experience happiness. This understanding fosters empathy and reduces conflict, both within yourself and in your interactions with the world.

Finally, Aṣṭāvakra uses the analogy of waves in the ocean. The entire universe, with all its apparent diversity, is simply a manifestation of the one reality, like waves arising and dissolving in the ocean. There is no separation between the waves and the ocean. Similarly, there is no separation between you and the ultimate reality. Aṣṭāvakra assures you that this is the truth and encourages you to be free from suffering, firmly established in the awareness of your true nature as pure consciousness. This realization dissolves anxiety and fear, leaving you in a state of profound peace and well-being.

In our modern lives, bombarded with distractions and driven by ambition, it's easy to lose sight of these fundamental truths. We become entangled in our thoughts and emotions, identifying with our ego and possessions. Aṣṭāvakra's teachings offer a powerful antidote. By cultivating awareness, practicing compassion, and recognizing the unity of all existence, you can break free from the cycle of suffering and live a life of joy, peace, and fulfillment.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify a situation in your life where you are clinging to a particular outcome or identity, and how might Aṣṭāvakra's teachings help you to find freedom in that situation?